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Suffolk Carbon Charter

Creating the Greenest County
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Date: Monday 12th February 2024

Dear Matthew,

Suffolk Carbon Charter - Bronze Level

Following Lighthouse Group's assessment on 8th November 2023, I am delighted to inform you the Charter Panel on the 31st January 2024 approved accreditation at Bronze Level. The Carbon Charter is awarded to organisations that are monitoring and reducing their carbon emissions. It is intended to provide public recognition of this vital step to our shared goal of Creating the Greenest County.

The Panel felt that Lighthouse are at the start of their lower carbon journey and have made many good first steps such as online learning courses to help reduce their staff and learners' business mileage and commuting emissions and using a modern building which does not use any oil or gas.

The Charter is about continual environmental improvement. The Panel identified the following recommendations as priority actions to investigate:

- Reduce emissions by minimum 10% over two years (5% per year). We recommend prioritising your business mileage and staff commuting from your employee-owned vehicles, as this makes up around 80% of your total emissions. You could consider an EV salary sacrifice scheme; installing EV chargers onsite; having a Cycle to Work/Active Travel scheme; and encouraging the use of public transport.
- Maintain robust data collection and monitoring systems for future carbon footprints, including keeping records of the split between commuting and business travel so that your future carbon footprints will be more accurate
- Switch your standard electricity tariff to a 100% renewable tariff
- Use your courses, website, and social media channels to educate your students about climate change, and champion your own emissions reductions to your customers and suppliers.
- Consider installing solar PV onsite.
- Evaluate the emissions from your servers (whether they are based on site or cloud-based).

If you're looking for inspiration on where to go next, the members website at www.carboncharter.org has a range of guides on environmental topics.

As a Charter company you are entitled to use the Carbon Charter logo provided. We would like to profile your company on the Carbon Charter website as well as in other opportunities as they arise. We hold regular Charter networking events and will be in touch with details of these and other offers.

Congratulations on your commendable achievement.

Yours sincerely,

Peter Frost

Environment Strategy Officer on behalf of the Carbon Charter Panel